

My children watched me lose everything through the GFC. We went from being quite wealthy to barely avoiding bankruptcy.

Through that time we relied heavily on credit, and over time I lost sight of the cost of credit card interest. At one point our debt got up to \$44 000.

Since becoming Barefoot we've smashed through most of it—though when I read we had to 'blend my card' I still had a momentary heart attack! But by the time we got to the Money Meal I had decided that I didn't need it. My biggest worry was wondering whether it would harm my blender (it didn't).

We showed the girls our credit card statements, and they were shocked at the interest and the impact it makes on getting the card paid off. I told them that if we weren't paying off credit we could pay our home loan off in less than seven years. The looks on their faces were priceless!

I think they really appreciated that we were showing them 'private' family information because it made them feel like we were treating them as adults.

And—they LOVED blending the credit card. They each got to have a chop of my card and watch it spin round and round like a black and silver cloud! I think it's a moment that will stay with them for life.

At the end of the night, we chanted: 'In our family we EARN interest, not pay it.'. I think that was one of our kids' favourite parts.

My 19-year-old was recently told she needed a credit card in order to get a good credit rating. Now she has the confidence to tell them, 'No!' Knowing that I'm going to help them be better financially than we have been is an awesome feeling.